

5.03 Continuous Random Variables

5.03a	Continuous random variables		a) Understand and be able to use the concept of continuous random variable, a probability density function (p.d.f.) and a cumulative distribution function (c.d.f.). <i>Includes the normal, continuous uniform and exponential distributions.</i> <i>Includes understanding informally the link between the exponential and Poisson distributions.</i> <i>Includes knowing and being able to use the formulae for the mean and variance of the continuous uniform and exponential distributions.</i> <i>For the underlying content on normal distributions, see sections 2.04e, 2.04f and 2.04g.</i>
5.03b	Probability density functions		b) Be able to use a probability density function (where defined piecewise) to solve problems in probabilities. <i>Includes knowing and being able to use $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) dx = 1$</i>
5.03c			c) Be able to calculate the mean and/or variance of a continuous random variable using the formulae $\mu = E(X) = \int x f(x) dx$ and $\sigma^2 = \text{Var}(X) = \int (x - \mu)^2 f(x) dx = \int x^2 f(x) dx - \mu^2$
5.03d			d) Be able to use the general result $E(g(X)) = \int g(x) f(x) dx$, where $f(x)$ is the probability density function of the continuous random variable X and $g(x)$ is a function of X.

OCR Ref.	Subject Content	Stage 1 learners should...	Stage 2 learners should additionally...
5.03e	Cumulative distribution functions		e) Be able to find and use a cumulative distribution function (including where defined piecewise problems involving probabilities. <i>Includes being able to use $F(x) = P(X \leq x) = \int_{-\infty}^x f(t) dt$</i>
5.03f			f) Know and be able to use the relationship between probability density function, $f(x)$, and the distribution function, $F(x)$, and use either the median, quartiles and other percentiles
5.03g			g) Be able to find and use the cumulative distribution functions of related variables. <i>e.g. Given the c.d.f. of X, find the c.d.f. of Y and p.d.f. of Y where $Y = X^3$.</i>